PORTLAND | Public Schools

TOGETHER, WE RISE

PPS Dual Language Immersion (DLI) Programs

TLE Committee

October 13, 2026

Agenda

01 Purpose of DLI

02 Current DLI Pathways

03 Rationale for Whole-School Model

04 Proposed Supports for DLI Transitions

05 Q & A

PROBLEM STATEMENT:

Our Spanish DLI programs are currently spread across 9 elementary school campuses and 6 middle school campuses. All but two of these programs are co-located with English Scholar neighborhood programs.

Challenges of the current model include: off-balance enrollment, resource distribution, staffing, educator collaboration & support.

The Purpose of DLI Programs

Grounded in dual language research

PURPOSE

PPS's Dual Language Immersion programs exist to build:

- **Bilingualism and Biliteracy**
- **Grade-level Academic Achievement**
- **Cross-Cultural Competency**

...for every student we serve, with particular attention to students of color and Multilingual Learners/English learners.

How DLI Should Be Implemented

1. **A shared, schoolwide vision** across staff, students, and families
2. **Equal visibility and status** for both languages
3. **Sufficient bilingual staffing** and true materials parity
4. **A coherent, sustained PreK-12 pathway. Students will earn the Oregon State Seal of Biliteracy upon Graduation.**

These conditions matter more than configuration (full-school vs. strand) alone.

Current Dual Language Enrollment & Capacity

PROGRAM GOAL

To ensure bilingualism and biliteracy, grade-level academic achievement, and social-cultural competency for every student we serve, particularly for our multilingual learners and our students of color.

DLI Program	Enrollment (K) 2026-27	Lottery Slots (K) 2026-27
Chinese	102	127
Japanese	101	104
Russian	14	25
Spanish	250	278
Vietnamese	38	52

CURRENT STATE

Where immersion students go: Dual Language Immersion assignments

How it works: after finishing 8th grade in a dual language immersion program, students are assigned to a high school that continues their language - not always their neighborhood school.

Spanish immersion

Home address decides. Upon completion of 8th grade Spanish DLI, students are assigned to a regional high school based on their home address.

IF YOUR HOME ADDRESS IS IN
Lincoln area · Ida B. Wells area

SPANISH DLI STUDENTS ATTEND THESE SCHOOLS

Lincoln High School
↑
West Sylvan Middle School
↑
Ainsworth Elementary

IF YOUR HOME ADDRESS IS IN 1
Roosevelt area · Jefferson area

SPANISH DLI STUDENTS ATTEND THESE SCHOOLS

Roosevelt High School
↑
Ockley Green Middle School ← Beach Elementary
George Middle School ← Sitton Elementary + James John Elementary
Cesar Chavez K-8 School (GRADES K-8)

IF YOUR HOME ADDRESS IS IN 1
McDaniel area · Grant area

SPANISH DLI STUDENTS ATTEND THESE SCHOOLS

Leodis V. McDaniel High School
↑
Beaumont Middle School ← Rigler Elementary
Roseway Heights Middle School ← Scott Elementary

IF YOUR HOME ADDRESS IS IN
Franklin area · Cleveland area

SPANISH DLI STUDENTS ATTEND THESE SCHOOLS

Franklin High School
↑
Kellogg Middle School
↑
Atkinson Elementary · Lent Elementary

Other immersion languages

These programs each follow one pathway. **Read from the bottom up:** elementary school to middle school to high school.

CHINESE
Jefferson High School ← Harriet Tubman Middle School ← Martin Luther King Jr. Elementary
Cleveland High School ← Harrison Park Middle School ← Woodstock Elementary + Clark Elementary

JAPANESE
Grant High School ← Mt. Tabor Middle School ← Richmond Elementary

RUSSIAN
Franklin High School ← Brentwood Middle School ← Kelly Elementary

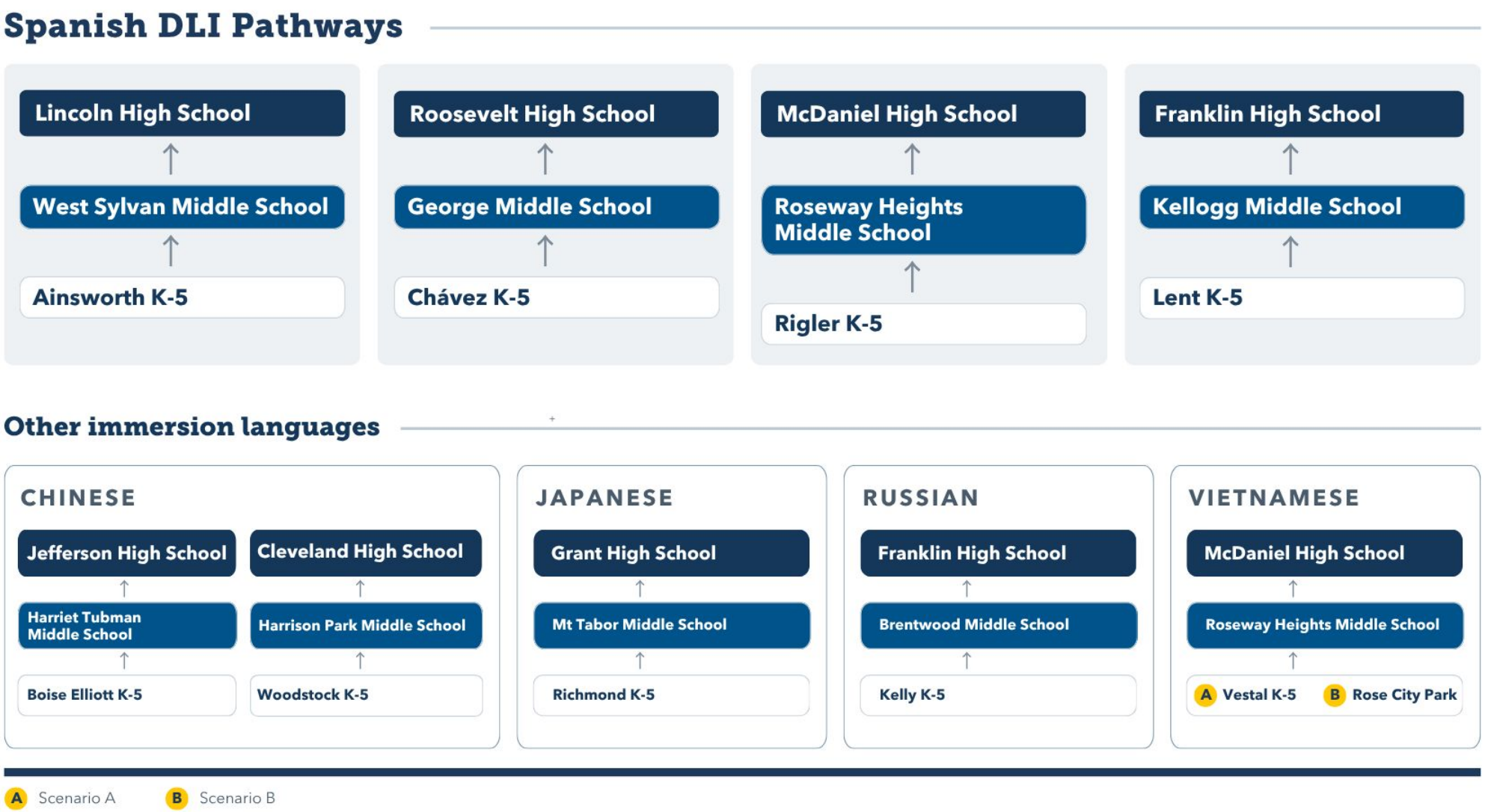
VIETNAMESE
Leodis V. McDaniel High School ← Roseway Heights Middle School ← Rose City Park Elementary

GOOD TO KNOW

1 James John, Rigler, Scott and Sitton primarily serve students who live in their neighborhoods.

Find Spanish Dual Language Neighborhood/Regional Priority Schools on the Enrollment & Transfer website.

Dual Language Immersion Pathways by Region
Proposed in Scenarios A & B



DLI Program Transportation--Current State

Overview of qualification, allocation policy, and application procedure

1. Qualification Notice

Enrollment & Transfer Letter

When a student is admitted into a PPS DLI program, the parent receives an official letter from the Enrollment and Transfer Center.

Eligibility Status

The letter explicitly indicates whether the student qualifies for district transportation to their assigned DLI program.

2. Targeted Allocation

Priority for Native Speakers

Allocated in collaboration with the PPS Transportation Department for Native and Heritage speakers entering Kindergarten.

Policy Alignment

Routes are designed to close the opportunity gap, aligned with district priorities and policies.

How to Request

Contact the school secretary. Office staff submit requests via the Transportation Request Web Link.

3. Hitcher Option

Hitcher Program

District resources currently do not allow for universal transportation for all DLI students.

Hitcher Program Access

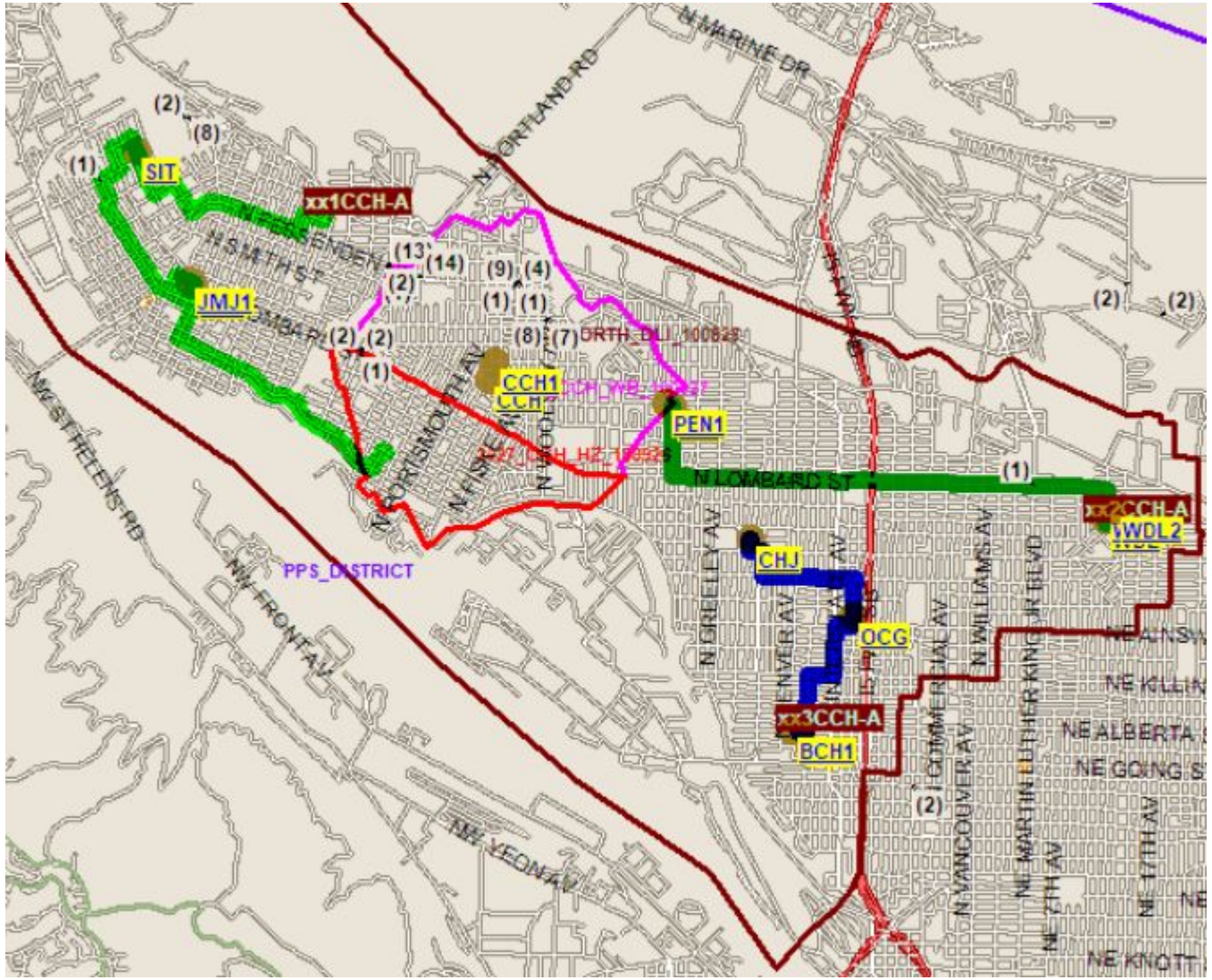
Any PPS student can request access to existing PPS bus routes through the hitcher program.

DLI Transportation--Future State

Snapshot of North Portland SDLI

Proposed Model

- 3-4 DLI dedicated Bus routes
- 10 -14 total bus stops across the region
- School and community center hub stops
- 20 min average per route



Whole-School DLI: What the Research Tells Us

Research on Dual Language Immersion points to five conditions that predict program strength — and a whole-school model is structurally best positioned to deliver all five:

01

Schoolwide Vision & Identity

A shared vision across staff, students, and families is one of the strongest predictors of program strength.

02

Equity & Language Status

Both languages should carry equal visibility and status schoolwide.

03

Program Coherence & Fidelity

Consistent, schoolwide implementation is most tied to stronger outcomes for English Learners — exactly what a full-school model is built to deliver.

04

Staffing & Resource Concentration

Sufficient bilingual staff and materials parity are essential, regardless of model.

05

Sustainable K–12 Pathways

DLI should be sustained PreK–12 — not evaluated one school at a time.

Takeaway: This is why PPS is moving toward whole-school DLI — it is the configuration most likely to reliably deliver these conditions at scale.

César Chávez--Moving to a Whole-School Model

César Chávez 2026-27 K-5 Enrollment

Grade	English Scholar	Spanish Immersion
Kinder	10	39
1st	11	38
2nd	12	34
3rd	13	26
4th	9	33
5th	10	44

Scenarios A/B →

César Chávez 2027-28 Proposed Enrollment

Grade	Spanish Immersion
Kinder	96
1st	93
2nd	84
3rd	76
4th	92
5th	100

César Chávez 2026-27 K-5 Demographics

Asian	3.5%
Black	9.5%
Latino	61%
Multiple	4.6%
Native Am.	1%
Pac Island.	1%
White	18.6%
ELL	37.5%
Special Ed.	20%

A PPS Proof Point: Lent Elementary

Lent has transformed into a successful whole-school DLI model — integrating language, curriculum, and a whole-school approach that has raised the bar for staff and produced better outcomes for students, particularly Multilingual Learners and English Learners, who are showing significant gains.

Lent's trajectory is exactly what the research conditions and the Collier & Thomas data predict for a well-implemented whole-school model.

Whole-School Coherence:

Every classroom, not just a strand, shares the same language identity and instructional model — the condition research ties most closely to stronger outcomes.

Concentrated Bilingual Staffing:

Staff plan and collaborate around one shared model instead of splitting across parallel programs.

Significant ML/EL Gains:

Since the shift to whole-school, Lent is seeing measurable gains for Multilingual Learners and English Learners specifically.

Feedback & Transition Planning

Overview of transition and program support planning

Gathering Feedback

Whole-School Lessons Learned

Focus groups with staff, families, and students in current whole-school communities to gather input on what works and needs work in this model

Impacted Communities Needs Assessment

Focus groups with staff, families, and students in school communities experiencing a program change to gather input on transition needs

Planning for Transition Supports

Dedicated Program Planning and Alignment

Supported time for new teams of building leaders and educators to plan for program transitions in Spring and Fall 2027.

Transportation Planning

Draft transportation routes available to families in Spring 2027.

Family Visits and Engagement Opportunities

Opportunities for families to engage together in and with their new school communities in Spring and Fall 2027.

Curriculum and Instructional Support Planning

Support from the Academics team to ensure educators have the curricular resources and guidance they need before Fall 2027.

Culturally-Specific Partnerships

Support from the RESJ & Partnerships team to ensure that new communities benefit from culturally and linguistically specific community partnerships.

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Discussion and Questions



DLI Research Sources

The research summary and Well-Resourced Schools alignment on the preceding slides draw on:

- Center for Applied Linguistics (CAL) — Guiding Principles for Dual Language Education, 3rd Edition
- National Clearinghouse for English Language Acquisition (NCELA) — Dual Language Immersion Playbook
- Institute of Education Sciences / What Works Clearinghouse — PPS Dual Language Immersion Study
- Education Northwest — PPS research partnership on DLI student and teacher outcomes
- PPS — Dual Language PreK–12 Program
- PPS — Why Dual Language?
- PPS — Spanish Immersion (Current DLI Programs)